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Request for Information: Development of an Artificial Intelligence Action Plan

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Comment on FR Doc # 2025-02305

Submitter Information

Email: [REDACTED]
Organization: Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers

General Comment

See attached file(s)

Attachments

AHAM Comments_NITRD AI Action Plan RFI_March 2025_FINAL

March 14, 2025

Via regulations.gov

Faisal D'Souza
Networking and Information Technology Research and Development
National Coordination Office
National Science Foundation
2415 Eisenhower Avenue
Alexandria, VA 22314, USA

Re: AHAM Comments on NITRD's Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan

Dear Mr. D'Souza:

On behalf of the Association of Home Appliance Manufacturers (AHAM), I am writing to provide our comments to the Office of Science and Technology Policy's Networking and Information Technology Research and Development (NITRD) National Coordination Office (NCO) on its Request for Information on the Development of an Artificial Intelligence (AI) Action Plan; 90 Fed. Reg. 9088 (Feb. 6, 2025). AHAM supports the development of an AI Action Plan that defines AI, recognizes the different areas of potential digital activities, and reviews regulations developed prior to the advent of AI for needed updates. These plan elements will help the agency develop policy actions needed to support AI innovation and ensure that unnecessary burdensome requirements do not hamper such innovation.

AHAM considers digital activities and their impacts in four categories:

- Safety: protection of life, limb, and property;
- Cybersecurity: protection of digital networks;
- Privacy: protection of the consumers' personal data; and
- Interoperability: creating an Internet of Things where connected devices can seamlessly "talk" to one another.

Like many industries, the home appliance industry is still trying to determine how rapid advances in AI can be deployed in terms of product design and consumer use cases. As part of their innovative initiatives, our member companies are making those determinations on an individual basis. Any government AI Action Plan should keep these four activity areas at the top-of-mind for consumer electrical and electronic devices and AI development should not compromise progress made in the four categories described above. Any regulations should be clear, protect consumers, and not burden innovation.

We note that from a policy and government perspective, there is no clear and commonly accepted definition of AI, particularly as it relates to consumer product applications. Development of a definition could be a worthwhile result of an AI Action Plan. The term "AI" is

used both with simpler rule-based algorithms and automation and with systems that have authentic learning and adaptive capabilities. Clear definitions will differentiate between these two approaches to product design and may, ultimately, lead to more informed consumer choice. Clarity also supports innovation and decreases the possibility that future regulation will be burdensome by providing a consistent understanding to innovators early on.

An AI Action Plan should also include a review of government regulations developed before the advent of AI to determine whether there are potential conflicts between existing government requirements and AI development. This is critical to ensure regulations do not unnecessarily hamper innovation.

AHAM appreciates the opportunity to submit comments to NITRD regarding its Request for Information and would be glad to discuss these matters in more detail should you request.

Respectfully submitted,

Sriram Gopal
Senior Director, Regulatory Policy & Circular Economy

About AHAM: AHAM represents more than 150 member companies that manufacture 90% of the major, portable and floor care appliances shipped for sale in the U.S. Home appliances are the heart of the home, and AHAM members provide safe, innovative, sustainable and efficient products that enhance consumers' lives. The home appliance industry is a significant segment of the economy, measured by the contributions of home appliance manufacturers, wholesalers, and retailers to the U.S. economy. In all, the industry drives nearly \$200 billion in economic output throughout the U.S. and manufactures products with a factory shipment value of more than \$50 billion.